

Part B

My Son the Fanatic

B1 My Son the Fanatic *Hanif Kureishi*

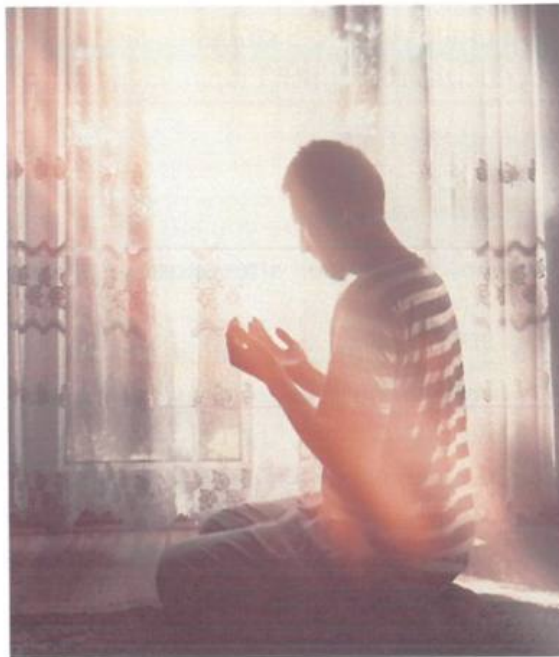
'My Son the Fanatic' was written by British author Hanif Kureishi and published in *The New Yorker* in 1994. The short story examines the tensions between a Pakistani immigrant and his son about their cultural identity in England. Read the text and complete the tasks that follow on pp. 30–33.

Surreptitiously, the father began going into his son's bedroom. He would sit there for hours, rousing himself only to seek clues. What bewildered him was that Ali was getting tidier. The room, which was usually a tangle of clothes, books, cricket bats and video games, was becoming neat and ordered; spaces began appearing where before there had been only mess.

Initially, Parvez had been pleased: his son was outgrowing his teenage attitudes. But one day, beside the dustbin, Parvez found a torn shopping bag that contained not only old toys but computer discs, videotapes, new books and fashionable clothes the boy had bought a few months before. Also without explanation, Ali had parted from the English girlfriend who used to come around to the house. His old friends stopped ringing.

For reasons he didn't himself understand, Parvez was unable to bring up the subject of Ali's unusual behaviour. He was aware that he had become slightly afraid of his son, who, between his silences, was developing a sharp tongue. One remark Parvez did make – 'You don't play your guitar any more' – elicited the mysterious but conclusive reply, 'There are more important things to be done.'

Yet Parvez felt his son's eccentricity as an injustice. He had always been aware of the pitfalls that other men's sons had stumbled into in England. It was for Ali that Parvez worked long hours; he spent a lot of money paying for Ali's education as an accountant. He had bought Ali good suits, all the books he required, and a computer. And now the boy was throwing his possessions out! The TV, video-player and stereo system followed the guitar. Soon the room was practically bare. Even the unhappy walls bore pale marks where Ali's pictures had been removed.



¹ **surreptitious**

[ˌsʌrəpˈtɪʃəs] done in secret

³ **bewilder sb.** [biˈwɪldə]

confuse sb., puzzle sb.

⁵ **tangle (n)** mess, chaos

²⁰ **elicit sth.** [ɪˈlɪt] etwas

hervorrufen

²³ **pitfall** trap

²⁵ **accountant**

Buchhalter/in

²⁹ **bear (bore, borne) sth.**

(v) (here) reveal sth.

Parvez couldn't sleep; he went more often to the whisky bottle, even when he was at work. He realised it was imperative to discuss the matter with someone sympathetic.

Parvez had been a taxi-driver for twenty years. Half that time he'd worked for the same firm. Like him, most of the other drivers were Punjabis. They preferred to work at night, when the roads were clearer and the money better. They slept during the day, avoiding their wives. They led almost a boy's life together in the cabbies' office, playing cards and setting up practical jokes, exchanging lewd stories, eating takeaways from local balti houses and discussing politics and their problems.

But Parvez had been unable to discuss the subject of Ali with his friends. He was too ashamed. And he was afraid, too, that they would blame him for the wrong turning his boy had taken, just as he had blamed other fathers whose sons began running around with bad girls, skipping school and joining gangs.

For years, Parvez had boasted to the other men about how Ali excelled in cricket, swimming and football, and what an attentive scholar he was, getting straight As in most subjects. Was it asking too much for Ali to get a good job, marry the right girl and start a family?

Once this happened, Parvez would be happy. His dreams of doing well in England would have come true. Where had he gone wrong?

One night, sitting in the taxi office on busted chairs with his two closest friends, watching a Sylvester Stallone film, Parvez broke his silence.

'I can't understand it!' he burst out. 'Everything is going from his room. And I can't talk to him any more. We were not father and son – we were brothers! Where has he gone? Why is he torturing me?' And Parvez put his head in his hands.

Even as he poured out his account, the men shook their heads and gave one another knowing glances.

'Tell me what is happening!' he demanded.

The reply was almost triumphant. They had guessed something was going wrong. Now it was clear: Ali was taking drugs and selling his possessions to pay for them. That was why his bedroom was being emptied.

'What must I do, then?'

Parvez's friends instructed him to watch Ali scrupulously and to be severe with him, before the boy went mad, overdosed or murdered someone.

Parvez staggered out into the early-morning air, terrified that they were right. His boy – the drug-addict killer!

To his relief he found Bettina sitting in his car.

Usually the last customers of the night were local 'brasses', or prostitutes. The taxi-drivers knew them well and often drove them to

³² **imperative** [im'perətiv] (adj) urgent and necessary

³⁶ **Punjabi** (n) (here) person originating from Punjab, a region in India and Pakistan

³⁹ **lewd** [lu:d, lju:d] *anstößig*

⁴⁰ **balti house** restaurant that serves balti, a type of Indian food

⁵³ **busted** (here) broken

⁶⁰ **pour [pɔ:] out your account** tell your story

⁶⁸ **watch sb. scrupulously** observe sb. closely

⁶⁹ **severe** [sɪ'viə] strict

liaisons. At the end of the girls' night, the men would ferry them home, though sometimes they would join the cabbies for a drinking session in the office. Occasionally, the drivers would go with the girls.

'A ride in exchange for a ride,' it was called.

80 Bettina had known Parvez for three years. She lived outside the town and, on the long drives home, during which she sat not in the passenger seat but beside him, Parvez had talked to her about his life and hopes, just as she talked about hers. They saw each other most nights.

85 He could talk to her about things he'd never be able to discuss with his own wife. Bettina, in turn, always reported on her night's activities. He liked to know where she had been and with whom.

Once, he had rescued her from a violent client, and since then they had come to care for each other.

90 Though Bettina had never met Ali, she heard about the boy continually. That night, when Parvez told Bettina that he suspected Ali was on drugs, to Parvez's relief, she judged neither him nor the boy, but said, 'It's all in the eyes.' They might be bloodshot; the pupils might be dilated; Ali might look tired. He could be liable to sweats, or sudden mood changes. 'OK?'

Parvez began his vigil gratefully. Now that he knew what the problem might be, he felt better. And surely, he figured, things couldn't have gone too far?

He watched each mouthful the boy took. He sat beside him at every opportunity and looked into his eyes. When he could, he took the boy's hand, checked his temperature. If the boy wasn't at home, Parvez was active, looking under the carpet, in Ali's drawers and behind the empty wardrobe – sniffing, inspecting, probing. He knew what to look for: Bettina had drawn pictures of capsules, syringes, pills, powders, rocks.

105 Every night, she waited to hear news of what he'd witnessed. After a few days of constant observation, Parvez was able to report that although the boy had given up sports, he seemed healthy. His eyes were clear. He didn't – as Parvez expected he might – flinch guiltily from his father's gaze. In fact, the boy seemed more alert and steady than usual: as well as being sullen, he was very watchful. He returned his father's long looks with more than a hint of criticism, of reproach, even – so much so that Parvez began to feel that it was he who was in the wrong, and not the boy.

'And there's nothing else physically different?' Bettina asked.

115 'No!' Parvez thought for a moment. 'But he is growing a beard.'

One night, after sitting with Bettina in an all-night coffee shop, Parvez came home particularly late. Reluctantly, he and Bettina had abandoned the drug theory, for Parvez had found nothing resembling any drug in Ali's room. Besides, Ali wasn't selling his belongings. He threw them out, gave them away or donated them to charity shops.

76 **liaison** [li'eizn] (here) secret sexual relationship

ferry sb./sth. drive sb./sth. from one place to another

79 **ride** (n, sl) sexual intercourse

94 **dilated** (here) wide open

be liable to sth. *anfällig sein für etwas*

96 **vigil** ['vidʒɪl] *Nachtwache*

104 **syringe** [sɪ'rɪndʒ] *Spritze*

108 **flinch from sth.** avoid sth. unpleasant (e.g. a look)

110 **sullen** grumpy, in a bad mood

Standing in the hall, Parvez heard the boy's alarm clock go off.

Parvez hurried into his bedroom, where his wife, still awake, was sewing in bed. He ordered her to sit down and keep quiet, though she had neither stood up nor said a word. As she watched him curiously, he
 25 observed his son through the crack of the door.

The boy went into the bathroom to wash. When he returned to his room, Parvez sprang across the hall and set his ear at Ali's door. A muttering sound came from within. Parvez was puzzled but relieved.

Once this clue had been established, Parvez watched him at other
 30 times. The boy was praying. Without fail, when he was at home, he prayed five times a day.

Parvez had grown up in Lahore, where all young boys had been taught the Koran. To stop Parvez from falling asleep while he studied, the maulvi had attached a piece of string to the ceiling and tied it to
 35 Parvez's hair, so if his head fell forward, he would instantly jerk awake. After this indignity, Parvez had avoided all religions. Not that the other taxi-drivers had any more respect than he. In fact, they made jokes about the local mullahs walking around with their caps and beards, thinking they could tell people how to live, while their eyes roved over
 40 the boys and girls in their care.

Parvez described to Bettina what he had discovered. He informed the men in the taxi office. His friends, who had been so inquisitive before, now became oddly silent. They could hardly condemn the boy for his devotions.

45 Parvez decided to take a night off and go out with the boy. They could talk things over. He wanted to hear how things were going at college; he wanted to tell him stories about their family in Pakistan.

More than anything, he yearned to understand how Ali had discovered the 'spiritual dimension', as Bettina called it.

50 To Parvez's surprise, the boy refused to accompany him. He claimed he had an appointment. Parvez had to insist that no appointment could be more important than that of a son with his father.

The next day, Parvez went immediately to the street where Bettina stood in the rain wearing high heels, a short skirt and a long mac,
 55 which she would open hopefully at passing cars.

'Get in, get in!' he said.

They drove out across the moors and parked at the spot where, on better days, their view unimpeded for miles except by wild deer and horses, they'd lie back, with their eyes half-closed, saying, 'This is the
 60 life.' This time Parvez was trembling. Bettina put her arms around him.

'What's happened?'

'I've just had the worst experience of my life.'

As Bettina rubbed his head, Parvez told her that the previous evening, as he and his son had studied the menu, the waiter, whom
 65 Parvez knew, brought him his usual whisky-and-water. Parvez was so

¹²⁸ **mutter** (v) murmur, speak to yourself

¹³⁴ **maulvi** ['mɔ:lvɪ] religious teacher of Islam

¹³⁶ **indignity** humiliation

¹³⁹ **rove over sb.** look at sb. with (sexual) desire

¹⁴² **inquisitive** [ɪn'kwɪzətɪv] nosy, asking a lot of questions

¹⁴⁴ **devotion** *Hingabe*

¹⁵⁴ **mac** raincoat

¹⁵⁸ **unimpeded** [ˌʌn-ɪm'pi:ɪd] (fml) not blocked by anything



nervous he had even prepared a question. He was going to ask Ali if he was worried about his imminent exams. But first he loosened his tie, crunched a poppadum and took a long drink.

Before Parvez could speak, Ali made a face.

170 'Don't you know it's wrong to drink alcohol?' he had said.

'He spoke to me very harshly,' Parvez said to Bettina. 'I was about to castigate the boy for being insolent, but I managed to control myself.'

Parvez had explained patiently that for years he had worked more than ten hours a day, had few enjoyments or hobbies, and never went
175 on holiday. Surely it wasn't a crime to have a drink when he wanted one?

'But it is forbidden,' the boy said.

Parvez shrugged, 'I know.'

'And so is gambling, isn't it?'

180 'Yes. But surely we are only human?'

Each time Parvez took a drink, the boy winced or made a fastidious face as an accompaniment. This made Parvez drink more quickly. The waiter, wanting to please his friend, brought another glass of whisky. Parvez knew he was getting drunk, but he couldn't stop himself. Ali
185 had a horrible look, full of disgust and censure. It was as if he hated his father.

Halfway through the meal, Parvez suddenly lost his temper and threw a plate on the floor. He felt like ripping the cloth from the table, but the waiters and other customers were staring at him. Yet he
190 wouldn't stand for his own son's telling him the difference between right and wrong. He knew he wasn't a bad man. He had a conscience.

There were a few things of which he was ashamed, but on the whole he had lived a decent life.

167 **imminent** about to take place

168 **crunch** (v) (*hier*)
knabbern

poppadum, poppadom
['pɒpədəm] crispy
Indian bread

172 **castigate sb.** scold sb.,
reprimand sb. (espe-
cially a child)

insolent ['ɪnsələnt]
impertinent, rude

181 **fastidious** [fæ'stɪdiəs]
(here) critical

185 **censure** ['senʃə] (n)
condemnation

'When have I had time to be wicked?' he asked Ali.

15 In a low monotonous voice the boy explained that Parvez had not, in fact, lived a good life. He had broken countless rules of the Koran.

'For instance?' Parvez demanded.

Ali didn't need to think. As if he had been waiting for this moment, he asked his father if he didn't relish pork pies.

10 'Well,' Parvez couldn't deny that he loved crispy bacon smothered with mushrooms and mustard and sandwiched between slices of fried bread. In fact, he ate this for breakfast every morning.

Ali then reminded Parvez that he had ordered his wife to cook pork sausages, saying to her, 'You're not in the village now. This is England.

15 We have to fit in.'

Parvez was so annoyed and perplexed by this attack that he called for more drink.

'The problem is this,' the boy said. He leaned across the table. For the first time that night his eyes were alive. 'You are too implicated in Western civilisation.'

Parvez burped; he thought he was going to choke. 'Implicated!' he said. 'But we live here!'

'The Western materialists hate us,' Ali said. 'Papa, how can you love something which hates you?'

15 'What is the answer, then,' Parvez said miserably, 'according to you?'

Ali didn't need to think. He addressed his father fluently, as if Parvez were a rowdy crowd which had to be quelled or convinced.

The law of Islam would rule the world; the skin of the infidel would 20 burn off again and again; the Jews and Christians would be routed. The West was a sink of hypocrites, adulterers, homosexuals, drug users and prostitutes.

While Ali talked, Parvez looked out the window as if to check that they were still in England.

25 'My people have taken enough. If the persecution doesn't stop, there will be jihad. I, and millions of others, will gladly give our lives for the cause.'

'But why, why?' Parvez said.

'For us, the reward will be in Paradise.'

30 'Paradise!'

Finally, as Parvez's eyes filled with tears, the boy urged him to mend his ways.

'But how would that be possible?' Parvez asked.

'Pray,' urged Ali. 'Pray beside me.'

15 Parvez paid the bill and ushered his boy out of there as soon as he was able. He couldn't take any more.

Ali sounded as if he'd swallowed someone else's voice.

194 **wicked** (adj) morally bad

199 **relish sth.** ['relɪʃ] enjoy sth.

200 **smother sb./sth.** (here) completely cover sb./sth.

209 **implicated in sth.** involved in sth., entangled in sth.

211 **burp** (v) *aufstoßen*

choke (v) *ersticken*

218 **quell sth.** suppress sth.

219 **infidel** ['ɪnfɪdəl, 'ɪnfɪdɪl] sb. who does not believe in a certain religion

220 **rout sb.** (v) completely defeat sb., destroy sb.

221 **hypocrite** ['hɪpəkrɪt] person who pretends to be a morally upright **adulterer** sb. who has sex outside of marriage

226 **jihad** holy Islamic war

231 **mend sth.** correct sth.

235 **usher sb.** guide sb., lead sb.

On the way home, the boy sat in the back of the taxi, as if he were a customer. 'What has made you like this?' Parvez asked him, afraid
 240 that somehow he was to blame for all this. 'Is there a particular event which has influenced you?'

'Living in this country.'

'But I love England,' Parvez said, watching his boy in the rear-view mirror. 'They let you do almost anything here.'

245 'That is the problem,' Ali replied.

For the first time in years, Parvez couldn't see straight. He knocked the side of the car against a lorry, ripping off the wing mirror. They were lucky not to have been stopped by the police: Parvez would have lost his licence and his job.

250 Back at the house, as he got out of the car, Parvez stumbled and fell in the road, scraping his hands and ripping his trousers. He managed to haul himself up. The boy didn't even offer him his hand.

Parvez told Bettina he was willing to pray, if that was what the boy wanted – if it would dislodge the pitiless look from his eyes. 'But what
 255 I object to,' he said, 'is being told by my own son that I am going to Hell!'

What had finished Parvez off was the boy's saying he was giving up his studies in accounting. When Parvez had asked why, Ali said sarcastically that it was obvious. 'Western education cultivates an
 260 anti-religious attitude.' And in the world of accountants it was usual to meet women, drink alcohol and practise usury.

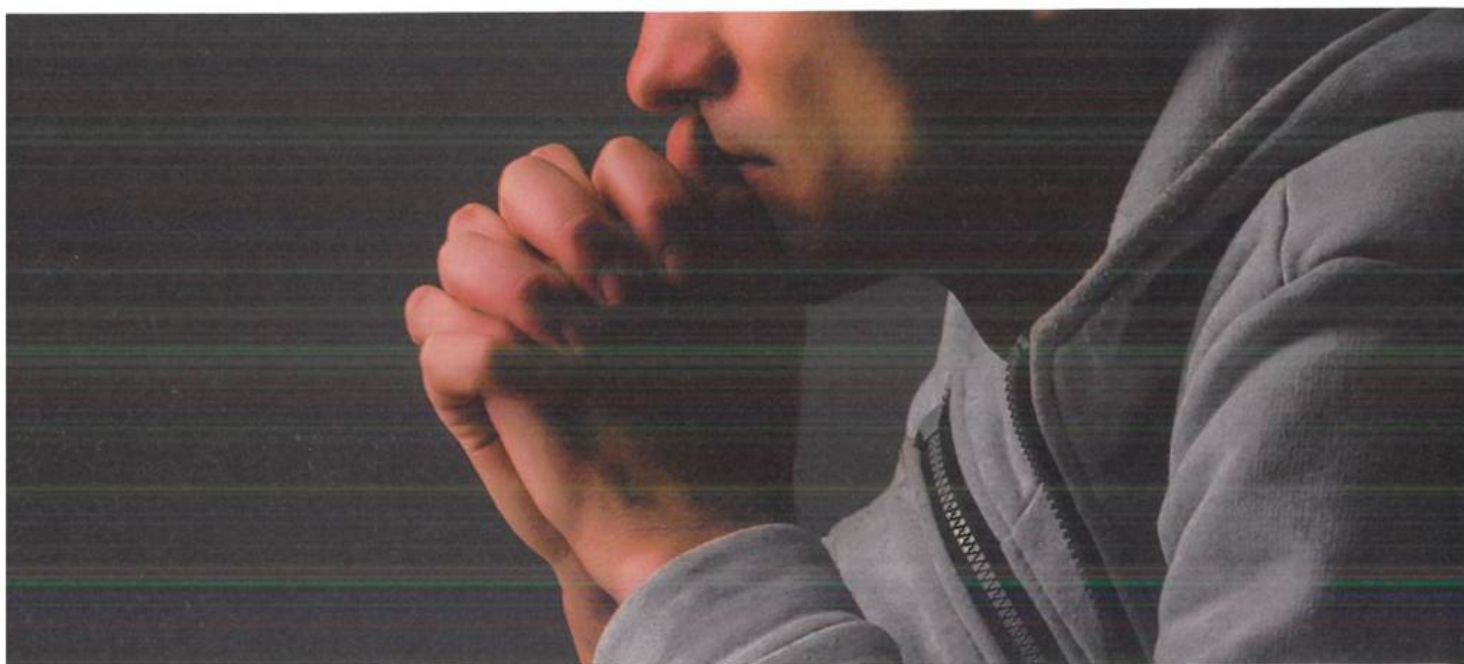
'But it's well-paid work,' Parvez argued. 'For years you've been preparing!'

265 Ali said he was going to begin to work in prisons, with poor Muslims who were struggling to maintain their purity in the face of corruption.

254 **dislodge sth. from sth.** (here) remove sth. from sth.

261 **usury** ['ju:ʒəri] *Wucher*

265 **corruption** (here) immorality



Finally, at the end of the evening, as Ali went up to bed, he had asked his father why he didn't have a beard, or at least a moustache.

'I feel as if I've lost my son,' Parvez told Bettina. 'I can't bear to be looked at as if I'm a criminal. I've decided what to do.'

70 'What is it?'

'I'm going to tell him to pick up his prayer mat and get out of my house. It will be the hardest thing I've ever done, but tonight I'm going to do it.'

'But you mustn't give up on him,' said Bettina. 'Many young people
75 fall into cults and superstitious groups. It doesn't mean they'll always feel the same way.' She said Parvez had to stick by his boy.

Parvez was persuaded that she was right, even though he didn't feel like giving his son more love when he had hardly been thanked for all he had already given.

30 For the next two weeks, Parvez tried to endure his son's looks and reproaches. He attempted to make conversation about Ali's beliefs.

But if Parvez ventured any criticism, Ali always had a brusque reply.

On one occasion, Ali accused Parvez of 'grovelling' to the whites; in contrast, he explained, he was not 'inferior'; there was more to the
35 world than the West, though the West always thought it was best.

'How is it you know that?' Parvez said. 'Seeing as you've never left England?'

Ali replied with a look of contempt.

One night, having ensured there was no alcohol on his breath,
90 Parvez sat down at the kitchen table with Ali. He hoped Ali would compliment him on the beard he was growing, but Ali didn't appear to notice it.

The previous day, Parvez had been telling Bettina that he thought people in the West sometimes felt inwardly empty and that people
95 needed a philosophy to live by.

'Yes,' Bettina had said. 'That's the answer. You must tell him what your philosophy of life is. Then he will understand that there are other beliefs.'

After some fatiguing consideration, Parvez was ready to begin. The
00 boy watched him as if he expected nothing.

Haltingly, Parvez said that people had to treat one another with respect, particularly children their parents. This did seem, for a moment, to affect the boy. Heartened, Parvez continued. In his view, this life was all there was, and when you died, you rotted in the earth.

05 'Grass and flowers will grow out of my grave, but something of me will live on.'

'How then?'

'In other people. For instance, I will continue – in you.'

At this the boy appeared a little distressed.

275 **superstitious** [ˌsu:pə-
ˈstɪʃəs] *abergläubisch*

281 **reproach** (n)
accusation

282 **venture sth.** (here)
risk to express sth.

283 **grovel** (v) [ˈgrɒvl] be-
have in a subservient
manner

301 **halting** [ˈhɔːltɪŋ] (adj)
hesitant

303 **hearten sb.** encourage
sb.

310 'And in your grandchildren,' Parvez added for good measure. 'But while I am here on earth I want to make the best of it. And I want you to, as well!'

'What d'you mean by "make the best of it"?' asked the boy.

'Well,' said Parvez. 'For a start ... you should enjoy yourself. Yes.

315 Enjoy yourself without hurting others.'

Ali said that enjoyment was a 'bottomless pit'.

'But I don't mean enjoyment like that,' said Parvez. 'I mean the beauty of living.'

'All over the world our people are oppressed,' was the boy's reply.

320 'I know,' Parvez replied, not entirely sure who 'our people' were, 'but still – life is for living!'

Ali said, 'Real morality has existed for hundreds of years. Around the world millions and millions of people share my beliefs. Are you saying you are right and they are all wrong?' Ali looked at his father

325 with such aggressive confidence that Parvez would say no more.

A few evenings later, Bettina was riding in Parvez's car after visiting a client when they passed a boy on the street.

'That's my son,' Parvez said, his face set hard. They were on the other side of town, in a poor district, where there were two mosques.

330 Bettina turned to see. 'Slow down then, slow down!'

She said, 'He's good-looking. Reminds me of you. But with a more determined face. Please, can't we stop?'

316 **pit** (n) wide hole



'What for?'

'I'd like to talk to him.'

35 Parvez turned the cab round and stopped beside the boy.

'Coming home?' Parvez asked. 'It's quite a way.'

The boy shrugged and got into the back seat. Bettina sat in the front. Parvez became aware of Bettina's short skirt, her gaudy rings and ice-blue eyeshadow. He became conscious that the smell of her
10 perfume, which he loved, filled the cab. He opened the window.

While Parvez drove as fast as he could, Bettina said gently to Ali, 'Where have you been?'

'The mosque,' he said.

'And how are you getting on at college? Are you working hard?'

15 'Who are you to ask me these questions?' he said, looking out of the window. Then they hit bad traffic, and the car came to a standstill.

By now, Bettina had inadvertently laid her hand on Parvez's shoulder. She said, 'Your father, who is a good man, is very worried about you. You know he loves you more than his own life.'

30 'You say he loves me,' the boy said.

'Yes!' said Bettina.

'Then why is he letting a woman like you touch him like that?'

If Bettina looked at the boy in anger, he looked back at her with cold fury.

35 She said, 'What kind of woman am I that deserves to be spoken to like that?'

'You know what kind,' he said. Then he turned to his father. 'Now let me out.'

'Never,' Parvez replied.

30 'Don't worry, I'm getting out,' Bettina said.

'No, don't!' said Parvez. But even as the car moved forward, she opened the door and threw herself out – she had done this before – and ran away across the road. Parvez stopped and shouted after her several times, but she had gone.

35 Parvez took Ali back to the house, saying nothing more to him. Ali went straight to his room. Parvez was unable to read the paper, watch television or even sit down. He kept pouring himself drinks.

At last, he went upstairs and paced up and down outside Ali's room. When, finally, he opened the door, Ali was praying. The boy didn't
70 even glance his way.

Parvez kicked him over. Then he dragged the boy up by the front of his shirt and hit him. The boy fell back. Parvez hit him again. The boy's face was bloody. Parvez was panting; he knew that the boy was unreachable, but he struck him none the less. The boy neither covered
75 himself nor retaliated; there was no fear in his eyes. He only said, through his split lip: 'So who's the fanatic now?'

From: *Love in a Blue Time*, London: Faber and Faber, 1997

338 **gaudy** ['gɔ:di] *kitschig*

347 **inadvertent** unintentional

368 **pace** (v) walk

373 **pant** (v) breathe quickly to catch your breath

375 **retaliate** [rɪ'tæliet] fight back

Info Hanif Kureishi

Hanif Kureishi (born 5 December 1954, in London) is considered one of Britain's most influential writers. His grandfather had been an affluent colonel in the Indian army before taking his family to Pakistan after the partition of the former British colony of India into the independent states of India and Pakistan in 1947. Later, Kureishi's father emigrated to England where he met Kureishi's English mother, Audrey Buss.

After receiving his A levels, Kureishi studied philosophy.

His works include novels, dramas, short stories and screenplays.

**First reaction**

- 1 **a Think:** What is your first reaction to the short story and its title?
Take short notes.
- b Pair:** Exchange your ideas with a partner.
- c Share:** **Speaking** Present your findings to the class.
- 2 **a** Together with a partner, come up with a definition of the term 'fanatic'. You can also use a dictionary or the internet for research.
- b** Give at least three suitable examples of fanatic behaviour.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____



Comprehension

- 3 Read the short story and put the following sentences in the right order. Write the numbers 1 to 12 in the column on the right after each sentence.

Sentence	Number
A After dinner, Ali explains that he is going to quit his education to help Muslims in prison.	
B Ali has stopped playing the guitar.	
C Parvez invites Ali to a restaurant, where Ali expresses his disapproval of his father's habits such as drinking alcohol and eating pork, which are forbidden by the Koran.	
D Ali blames his father for having adopted too much of the liberal Western culture and warns of an impending jihadist backlash.	
E Parvez tries to teach his son that he has to enjoy life while he can. Ali rejects that notion on moral grounds.	
F Parvez, a taxi driver, is too ashamed to bring up the changes in Ali with his friends because he has always been proud of his son's exemplary behaviour.	
G Parvez is worried because his son has suddenly become tidy and has started throwing out all his favourite games and clothes.	
H Ali insults Bettina when she tries to reason with him. Later that evening, Parvez snaps and beats his son, who refuses to fight back.	
I Parvez's friends warn him that Ali has become a drug addict and is selling his belongings to finance his addiction.	
J Parvez discusses his son's strange behaviour with his friend Bettina, who works as a prostitute.	
K Parvez does not discover any clues to sustain the theory that Ali is taking drugs and instead finds him in his room praying five times a day.	
L Parvez works long hours to provide for his son's accounting education and for his comfort at home.	

- 4 Point out Ali's change of character.
- 5 Describe Parvez's development from his childhood in Lahore to his life as an immigrant in England.

Analysis

- 6 Examine Parvez's relationship with Bettina.
- 7 Compare Parvez's and Ali's views of living in England as (Muslim) immigrants. Use the following quotes as a starting point:

Parvez: 'You're not in the village now. This is England. We have to fit in.' (ll. 204–205)

Ali: 'You are too implicated in Western civilisation.' (ll. 209–210)

- Parvez: 'They let you do almost anything here.'
- Ali: 'That is the problem'. (ll. 244–245)



- 8 Read the scene at the restaurant again (ll. 163–236). Examine the language Parvez and Ali use to try to convince each other.

Info Language

When analysing language, it is important to be aware of how the text is written. To do so, you need to find certain language features and explain their possible effect. These include the choice of words, the sentence structure (e.g. short / long / simple / sophisticated), stylistic devices (e.g. metaphor / alliteration / repetition of words), exclamatory remarks, punctuation, tone (e.g. ironic / happy / angry / sarcastic) and register (e.g. formal / informal / slang).

- 9 Work with a partner. Discuss whether Parvez is a good father. Use examples from the text to support your view.

Beyond the text

- 10 a In groups of three, prepare a dialogue between Parvez, his wife and Ali after Parvez has beaten Ali.
b **Speaking** Perform your scene for the class.
- 11 **Writing** Write Parvez's letter of apology to his son.
- 12 'State multiculturalism has failed and left young Muslims vulnerable to radicalization.' Discuss this quote from former British Prime Minister David Cameron at the Munich Security Conference on 5 February 2011. Refer to the short story 'My Son the Fanatic'.

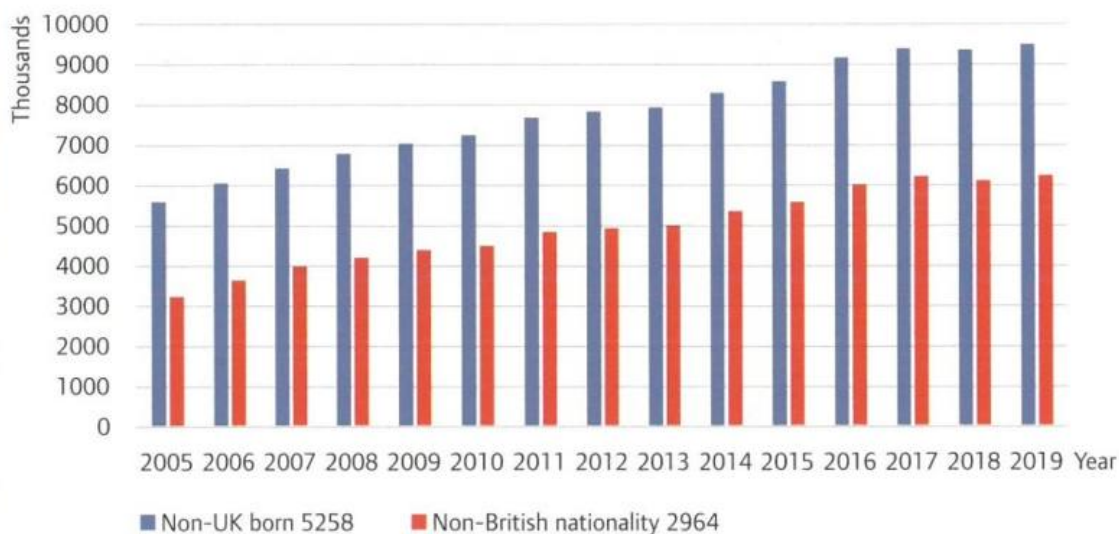


David Cameron at the Munich Security Conference (5 February 2011)

B2 Diversity in the UK

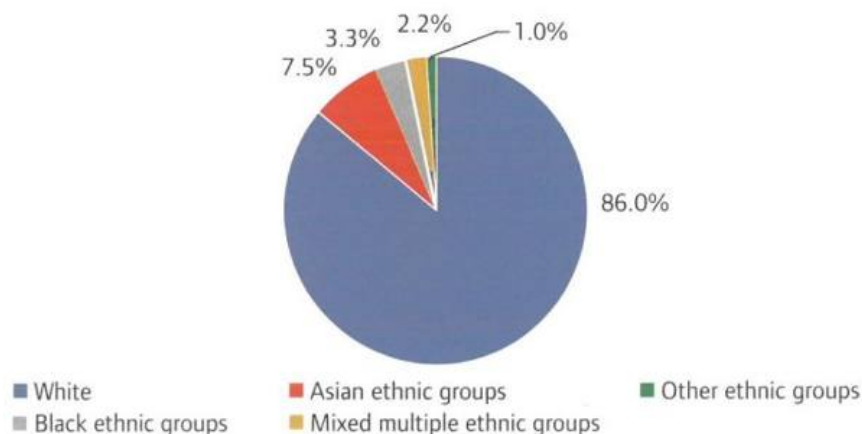
- 1 a Work with a partner. Each choose one of the statistics below and present your data to your partner. Discuss possible consequences for Britain's society.
- b Prepare a short presentation in which you reveal the consequences discussed. Refer to the statistics.
- c **Speaking** Give your presentation to the class.

Estimates of the non-UK-born and non-British resident population of the UK, 2005 to 2019



Source: Office for National Statistics – Annual Population Survey

Ethnic population of England and Wales according to the 2011 Census



Source: Diversity UK

- 2 a Read the info box (→ Info box, p. 30) about the author of the short story again.
- b **Viewing** Watch an interview with him provided by the British Library and take notes on his views on culture.
- c **Speaking** Present your findings to your class.

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